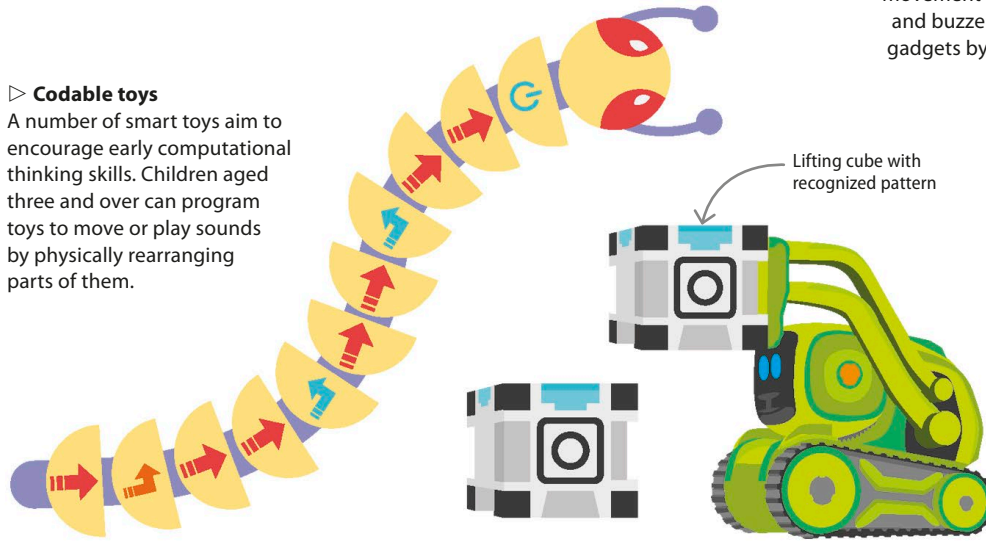


Integrating digital and physical

Smart toys can make a useful contribution to a child's learning experience. This is particularly true when they are combined with play and learning in the real world. Toys that use technology to simulate real-world technologies such as telephones, shop tills, and office equipment can be used as part of imagination-boosting role-playing games with other children or parents. Smart toys that reinforce physical learning activities, such as counting with objects or learning to read and spell, are also beneficial.

▷ Codable toys

A number of smart toys aim to encourage early computational thinking skills. Children aged three and over can program toys to move or play sounds by physically rearranging parts of them.



Wearable toys △

Wearable toys contain sensors that detect movement and other elements such as lights and buzzers. Children can create games and gadgets by coding them to react to different sorts of movement.

Little robots ◁

Smart toys include robots with machine-learning programs that let them recognize their owner, and learn about their environment. They can also do tasks such as lifting objects, or recognizing patterns.

Creative tools

Many electronic and digital tools aim to teach children literacy or numeracy skills, but they can also be used to encourage creativity and exploration. One example is showing children how to make stop-motion films with modelling clay or toys, using a simple digital camera and a video-editing program. They can then add a voiceover or music by recording it themselves, or getting sounds from the internet.

▷ Keep in touch

Technology can be a useful tool for maintaining social links. Including children in the process of emailing or video-calling family or friends living far away is a good way to help them learn more.

